

FROM DATA TO DECISIONS

A Data & Insight Strategy for the Sweet1ne Visual Menu Platform

Prepared by GlobalSolutions · June 2026

This report works through a set of questions raised internally about the analytics layer of the Sweet1ne platform. The proposal already defines what data the system captures — QR scans, dish views, search terms, category views, and orders. The questions below go a step further: what should happen to that data once it exists, and how should the platform be designed so that data turns into decisions rather than sitting unused in a dashboard.

What else can we do with the data the platform gives us?

Beyond reporting raw numbers, the platform can be designed to interpret them. Every data point the system already plans to capture — scans, views, searches, orders — can be paired with a second layer that compares it against a benchmark (last week, the branch average, or a target) and flags what is worth attention. In practice this means the dashboard does not just show “Jerk Chicken: 240 views”; it shows “Jerk Chicken is viewed three times more than it is ordered — worth checking the price or description.” The data itself does not change; what changes is whether someone has to go looking for the story inside it, or whether the platform tells the story unprompted.

What does the data tell us?

On its own, each metric tells a narrow, factual story: how often the menu was opened, which dishes were viewed, what customers searched for, which categories drew attention, and what was actually ordered. None of these numbers are meaningful in isolation — a dish with 200 views means nothing without knowing whether that is high or low for the branch, the week, or the dish's price point. The real answer to “what does the data tell us” is that, by itself, it tells us what happened. It takes a second layer of comparison and pattern-spotting to say what it means.

How does it inform us?

The data informs decisions only once it is connected to a reference point. Scan rate informs us about table-side engagement when compared to footfall or covers served. Dish views inform us about menu appeal when compared to order conversion for that same dish. Search terms inform us about unmet demand when no existing dish matches what is being searched. In each case, the informing step is a comparison — this number against that number — and the platform should be the one running that comparison automatically rather than leaving it to an owner to notice.

What does the information turn into? What actions?

Once a number has been compared and a pattern identified, it should resolve into a specific, low-effort action rather than a general observation. A few examples of how this could work in practice: a dish viewed often but rarely ordered triggers a suggestion to revisit its price, description, or photo. A dish not viewed in two weeks triggers a suggestion to feature or remove it. A rising volume of searches for a term with no matching dish (e.g. “vegan”) triggers a suggestion to consider adding one. A branch-level drop in scan rate triggers a prompt to check QR code placement or table visibility. The goal is that every insight the platform surfaces comes attached to a next step, not just a statistic.

Is there a way the platform asks itself these questions and answers in the most optimised manner?

Yes — this is best built as a recommendation layer that sits on top of the raw analytics rather than as a separate manual reporting process. The platform would periodically run a fixed set of checks against the incoming data (engagement trends, view-to-order conversion, search-demand gaps, branch comparisons) and surface only the results that cross a meaningful threshold, so owners are not asked to interpret a wall of charts. This is a natural and well-scoped version 2 feature: version 1 establishes reliable data capture, and the recommendation layer is built once there is enough real data from the pilot to calibrate what “normal” looks like for Sweet1ne specifically, so the suggestions are accurate rather than generic from day one.

Are we collecting the data margins Sweet1ne wants? What data margins are important to them?

This is not yet known, and it should not be assumed — it needs to be asked directly. The current proposal captures a sensible default set of metrics (scans, views, searches, categories, orders), but the metrics that actually matter to Sweet1ne's owners may be narrower or different: it could be margin per dish rather than volume, peak-hour performance, or comparison between the two branches specifically. The setup phase of the project is the right place to ask this directly, so the dashboard is built around the decisions Sweet1ne actually needs to make rather than a generic analytics template.

How much does Sweet1ne currently use data, and what does that mean for this project?

The likely answer is very little, not because the data does not matter to them but because, like most independent restaurant operators, they do not have the time to extract insight from raw numbers on top of running service. This is not a limitation on the opportunity — it is the opportunity itself. If Sweet1ne is not currently using data, the platform should not simply hand them more of it; it should do the work of collecting, interpreting, and presenting it as ready-made answers. Positioned this way, the analytics layer becomes a genuine operational advantage for Sweet1ne rather than another dashboard they do not have time to check.

BRAND & VISUAL DIRECTION

Sweet1ne's existing site and brand identity centre on a warm gold tone (#D4AF37) set against an ivory and white base, reflecting the “soul meets food” positioning of the restaurant. The platform's UI — customer menu, staff dashboard, and any future insight layer — should carry this same ivory, white, and gold palette through consistently, so the digital experience reads as a natural extension of the Sweet1ne brand rather than a generic third-party tool.